

01

Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Theory of reality, anekāntavāda, dravya-guṇa-paryāya, saptabhaṅgī, material karma, bondage and liberation are CORE SYLLABUS.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The Jaina pramāṇa scheme, seven nayas, karma taxonomy and guṇasthānas are CORE SUPPORTING DEPTH where they explain PYQs.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Sectarian minutiae and unverified legal detail are not answer targets.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Sectarian minutiae and unverified legal detail are not answer targets.

ANSWER LINE: Theory of reality, anekāntavāda, dravya-guṇa-paryāya, saptabhaṅgī, material karma, bondage and liberation are CORE SYLLABUS.

02

Contemporary-anchor discipline

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Fact: A live August 2026 search primarily returned contemporary educational discussion of anekāntavāda and continuing ethical discussion of sallekhanā, not a clearly verified new court ruling in the February–August window.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

□□ Inference: Use anekāntavāda as a conceptual resource for intellectual humility and sallekhanā as a bounded ethics application.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Do not invent a fresh legal development or let current application replace the printed metaphysics–logic–liberation syllabus.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

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ANSWER LINE: □ Fact: A live August 2026 search primarily returned contemporary educational discussion of anekāntavāda and continuing ethical discussion of sallekhanā, not a clearly verified new court ruling in the February–August window.

03

Master distinction gateway

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Master verdict: Jainism is pluralistic realism with epistemic non-absolutism and a material theory of karmic bondage; its unity lies in linking ontology, knowledge, conduct and liberation.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Reality contains many genuine aspects; finite knowers see only some of them; statements must therefore be qualified; and right knowledge must transform conduct so that karmic bondage can end.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Reality contains many genuine aspects; finite knowers see only some of them; statements must therefore be qualified; and right knowledge must transform conduct so that karmic bondage can end.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

A live 2026 search found contemporary discussion of anekāntavāda and sallekhanā, used only as labelled conceptual application rather than doctrinal authority.

ANSWER LINE: Recommended opening definition: Jainism (Jina-centred path of many-sided reality and liberation) is a pluralist realism in which anekāntavāda (doctrine of many-sided reality) holds that enduring dravya (substance) possesses guṇa (qualities) and changing paryāya (modes).